

Everyone Else • 30/39 • Sayyida Ma'suma

As Far As Qom. Ma'suma set out from Medina to reach her brother, Imam al-Rida, and got only as far as Qom. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

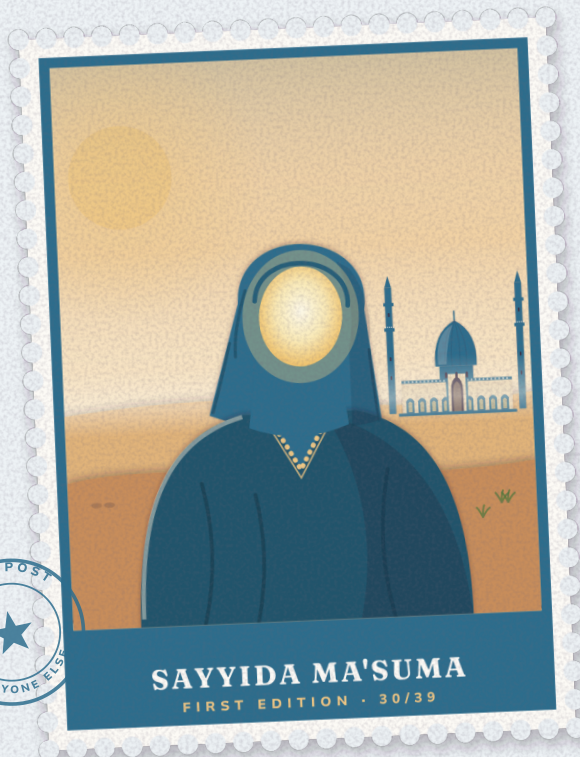
ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

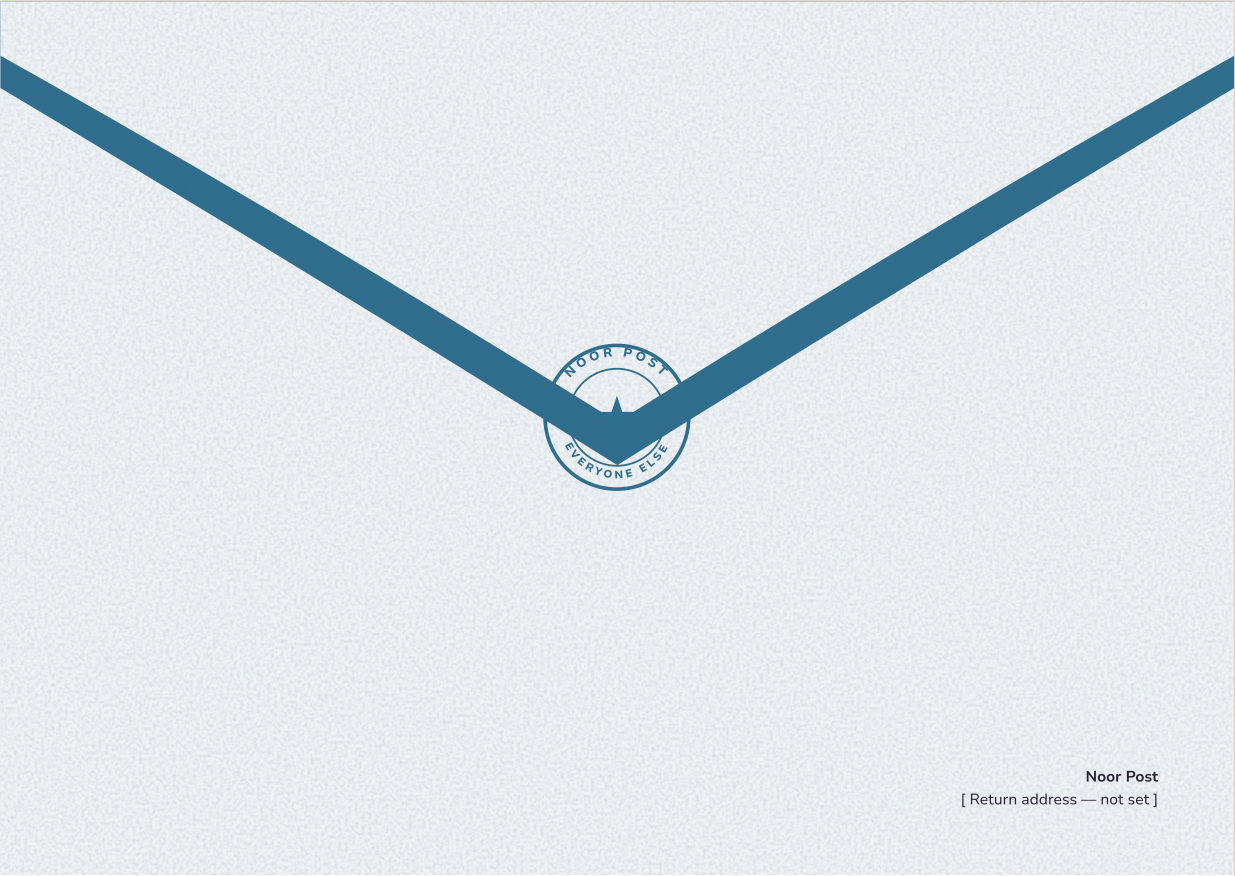
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

**Ma'suma set out from
Medina to reach her
brother, Imam al-Rida,
and got only as far as
Qom.**

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE ·
SAYYIDA MA'SUMA ·
INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

Sayyida Ma'suma

- **Who she was.** Fatima bint Musa, sister of Imam al-Rida, daughter of Imam al-Kadhim.
- **What she did.** Set out from Medina toward Khurasan to reach her brother after he was summoned there by the caliph al-Ma'mun.
- **What happened.** She fell seriously ill on the journey and stopped at Qom, where she died, never completing the journey to Khurasan.
- **What stands there now.** Her shrine at Qom, around which the city grew into one of the most significant centres of learning and pilgrimage in the region.
- **Why she is in this envelope.** *Ma'suma set out from Medina to reach her brother, Imam al-Rida, and got only as far as Qom.*

Her shrine continues to be visited by pilgrims from across the world.

UNVERIFIED — POWER

As Far As Qom



• is the grown-up · ◦ is you · ●◦ is together

- When Imam al-Rida was ordered across the empire to Khurasan and did not come back, his sister Fatima decided she was not going to sit in Medina waiting for news of him.

◦ Why was he in Khurasan?

- Because the caliph had sent for him and named him his heir, which sounds like a gift and was not one. He went because refusing was not on offer. Her whole journey begins with somebody else's decision about her brother.

◦ She went after him?

- She did. Over a thousand miles, most of it on roads nobody travelled for pleasure, to reach a brother the government had every reason to be watching.

◦ Did she get there?

- No. She got as far as a town called Qom, and there she fell ill, and could not go on.

◦ How far was she from him?

AS FAR AS QOM · CONTINUED

- Hundreds of miles still. She died in Qom without seeing him again.

◦ **So the journey failed?**

- By the only measure she had in mind, yes. She set out to reach her brother, and she did not reach her brother.

◦ **Then what happened?**

- She was buried where she stopped. People started coming to the grave almost at once and never stopped coming. A town grew into a city around it. Qom is one of the great places of learning in the world now — libraries, teachers, students from everywhere — and the reason any of it is there is a journey that ran out.

◦ **Is Ma'suma her name?**

- It is a title people gave her later. Her name was Fatima, after her grandmother. The name half the world knows her by is one nobody ever called her to her face.

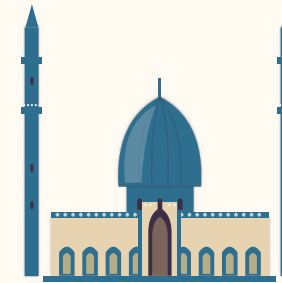
◦ **Has anything you started stopped halfway? Say what it was.**

- Most things do, for most people. Hers is the clearest case anyone could ask for that where you stop and what you started are two different questions, and that the second one is not settled by the first.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**She never reached him. A
city grew where she
stopped.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION · 30/39

IMAM AL-RIDA SAID

**“The elder brother is as
same as the father.”**

Imam al-Rida

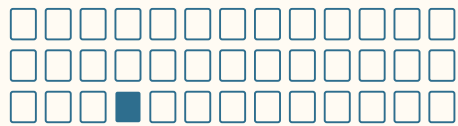


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

An older brother is like a father.

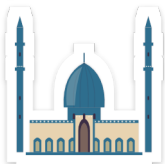
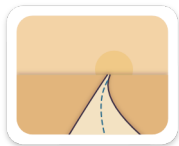
Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

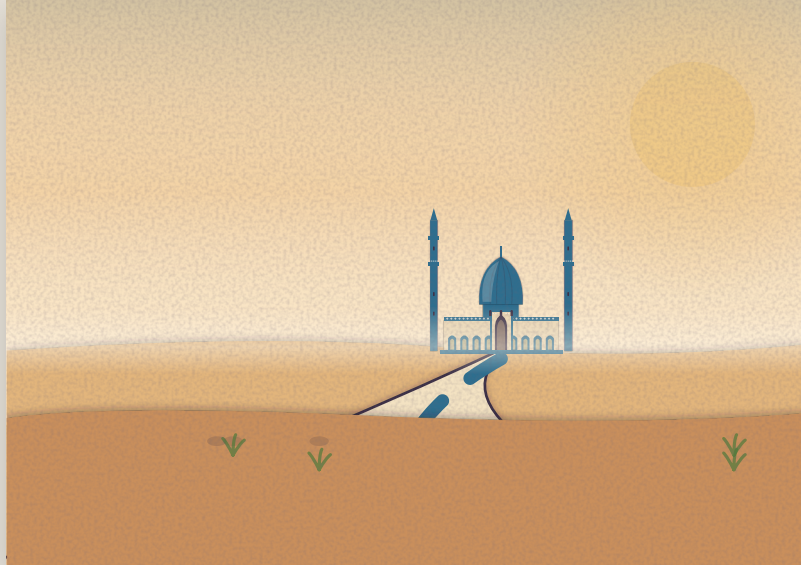
Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims of Imam al-Rida, no. 10. Translated by
Badr Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number



Sayyida Ma'suma





**We opened this one
together.**

- _____
- _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.



Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
